



or advertising, but are presented as role models, recounting their experiences of how they have overcome discrimination, inspiring others to be resilient and to achieve. We are aligned with them, positioned to view the world from their perspective.

For example, a feature on **Munroe Bergdorf**, interviewed by Rhona Ezuma in 2017, includes a fashion shoot displaying branded clothing. The interview presents her as a social media activist, as a transwoman at a time when prejudice was even more vicious than it is now. The images show Bergdorf from a low angle, a figure to be looked up to. Bergdorf was not as well-known then, and her career since has taken off. One of the ambitions and achievements that THIIIRD is proud of is championing those who are perhaps at the start of their career, giving them a spotlight to help them on their way.

*'Being someone who is unafraid enough to start the conversations that need to be started takes guts, and Munroe Bergdorf certainly has them. She chooses to use her voice not only to make things better for herself and others like her - people who identify as black, trans, queer and/ or womxn - but also for those whose plights are very different from hers, but still face ignorance, discrimination and microaggressions within society. Race, class, gender and ability all affect how we experience the world, and how we are received by it. To a certain extent, the more poor, queer, disabled or coloured you are, the more at a disadvantage you can be in wider society. This is something she wants us to be aware of, in order to make us do better and be better allies.'*⁷

Swimming the Race is the title of an interview with **Rebecca Achieng Ajulu-Bushell**, the first Black woman to swim for Team GB. She has been world number one, Kenyan Sports Personality of the Year, and world school's champion. For Rebecca, the impact of intersectionality is triple.

*'Raised within both Black and white communities, Rebecca was confronted with the dichotomy between her mixed racial identities from an early age. She explains: "In the UK I'm Black, for the most part, then in South Africa I was coloured. In Kenya, kids would be like "Mzungu! Mzungu!" which means white person, and I'd be like 'where? who? Oh, it's me!'"*⁸

The article **'The Personal is Political Project: What is Gender?'** from June 2023 takes advantage of the hyper-modality available to the website and presents a series of short video interviews with a group of 20-somethings. Each 'episode' poses a new question about how they perceive the issue of gender. Their answers encompass their own sense of identity, from gender pronouns to their sexuality, their race, faith and family background, regional and cultural heritage. Each aspect intersects in different ways for each individual. Their answers accumulatively demonstrate that gender is fluid, socially constructed and changes in context. Each episode has been filmed and edited by THIIIRD.⁹



Image by Ciáran Christopher / Thiiirdmagazine.co.uk

Caption: Image from the article 'The Personal is Political Project: What is Gender?'

⁷ Munroe Bergdorf interview by Rhona Ezuma, extract from THIIIRD's print Issue III: Journeys, 2018. [Interview with Munroe Bergdorf](#)

⁸ interview with Rebecca Achieng Ajulu-Bushell, Swimming the Race, THIIIRD Issue #6 p94 2022

⁹ <https://www.thiiirdmagazine.co.uk/stories/pip-project>